A-A-53996
10 October 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOOTHBRUSH, POST-SURGICAL, Ultra-soft

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This commercial item description covers an ultra-soft toothbrush suitable for post-surgical use, following dental procedures or as an adjunct to oral radiation treatment or chemotherapy.

Salient characteristics.

The toothbrush shall be suitable for use in the dry-brushing technique. The nylon bristles of the toothbrush shall be 0.003 ± 0.0005 inches in diameter.

The toothbrush shall be a multi-tufted design consisting of 9 rows of 4 tufts, 1 row of 3 tufts, and 1 row of 2 tufts, arranged from rear to front of the toothbrush head. Each tuft shall be composed of 225 to 275 bristle ends. The tufts shall be anchored in holes in the toothbrush by nickel-silver or other corrosion-resistant metal staples.

The bristles shall be constructed of mono-filament white (natural) No. 612 nylon. The bristles shall be end-rounded and shall be lightly textured (finished) on the last 30% of bristle length to enhance capillary action. Such end-rounding and finishing shall be done with a polishing machine.

The toothbrush body shall be polypropylene and shall consist of a head and neck and suitable straight handle. The toothbrush shall be provided with a polypropylene maintainer cover capable of protecting and concentrating the bristle surface and reducing the incidence of splaying. The toothbrush and maintainer cover shall be in accordance with Figures 1 and 2.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

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Toothbrush bodies and maintainer covers shall be red. The color shall be certified by the Food and Drug Administration under the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act.

Toothbrushes and maintainer covers shall be autoclavable and be capable of being chemically disinfected. They shall be tested as specified below.

Bristles shall not break or become detached from the toothbrush when up to 5 lbs. of pull is exerted on them. The pull test shall be as specified below.

Workmanship. Toothbrushes shall be clean and free of defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 144 toothbrushes, as specified, constitutes one unit. Each toothbrush shall be individually sealed in a clear plastic tube. The toothbrushes shall be packaged in a suitable box.

Quality Assurance Provisions

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or materials, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government.

Sampling.

For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be S-1 for microscopic examination and S-2 for visual examination. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one toothbrush.

For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, at inspection level S-1. The unit of product for testing shall be one toothbrush.

Examination. The toothbrushes shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements. The toothbrushes shall be examined for defects including, but not limited to, those listed below.

Defects.

Toothbrush and maintainer cover not of the design specified; maintainer cover missing.
Toothbrush body dimensions not as specified.
Maintainer cover does not fit properly on toothbrush.
Bristles not white (natural) in color.
Tufts not securely fastened in holes.
Bristles crimped, kinked, or splayed excessively.
Bristle diameter or length not as specified.
Number and arrangement of tufts not as specified.
Number of bristle ends per tuft not as specified.
Toothbrush body not smooth; sharp corners, edges, nicks, or chips present.
Toothbrush color not as specified.
Hole in toothbrush handle missing.
Toothbrushes not individually sealed in plastic tubes.

Microscopic examination of bristles. Miscroscopic examination of the toothbrush bristles shall be conducted on one tuft. Bristles shall be "ideal" or "acceptable" as shown in Figure 3, when examined with a binocular microscope with a 20 power (20x) lens and a setting of 1.5 (30x magnification).

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The number of defective ("not acceptable" as shown in Figure 3) bristles shall be noted. The number of defective bristles in the tuft shall be divided by the total number of bristles in the tuft and the percentage of defective bristles calculated by multiplying by 100. If the percentage is over 38 percent the brush shall be considered defective.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Autoclavability test. The toothbrush shall be autoclaved at 121°C ± 2°C for 20 minutes. After removal from the autoclave, the toothbrush shall be dried in an oven at 70°C for 3 hours. The toothbrush body shall show no softening, and the bristles shall show no discoloration or change in stiffness.

Pull test. The toothbrush shall be mounted in a Chatillon or other standard breaking strength testing machine. One tuft of bristles shall be gripped and a pull exerted on it. The pull shall be gradually increased to 5 lbs. The bristles shall not break or become detached from the toothbrush.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6520-01-273-3583	TOOTHBRUSH, POST-SURGICAL, Ultra-soft 0.003 inch (0.076 mm) Diameter Bristle, 6-1/4 inch (15.9 cm) Long, Multi-tufted, 144s

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6520-2208

LOCATION: NCR Disk No. 7

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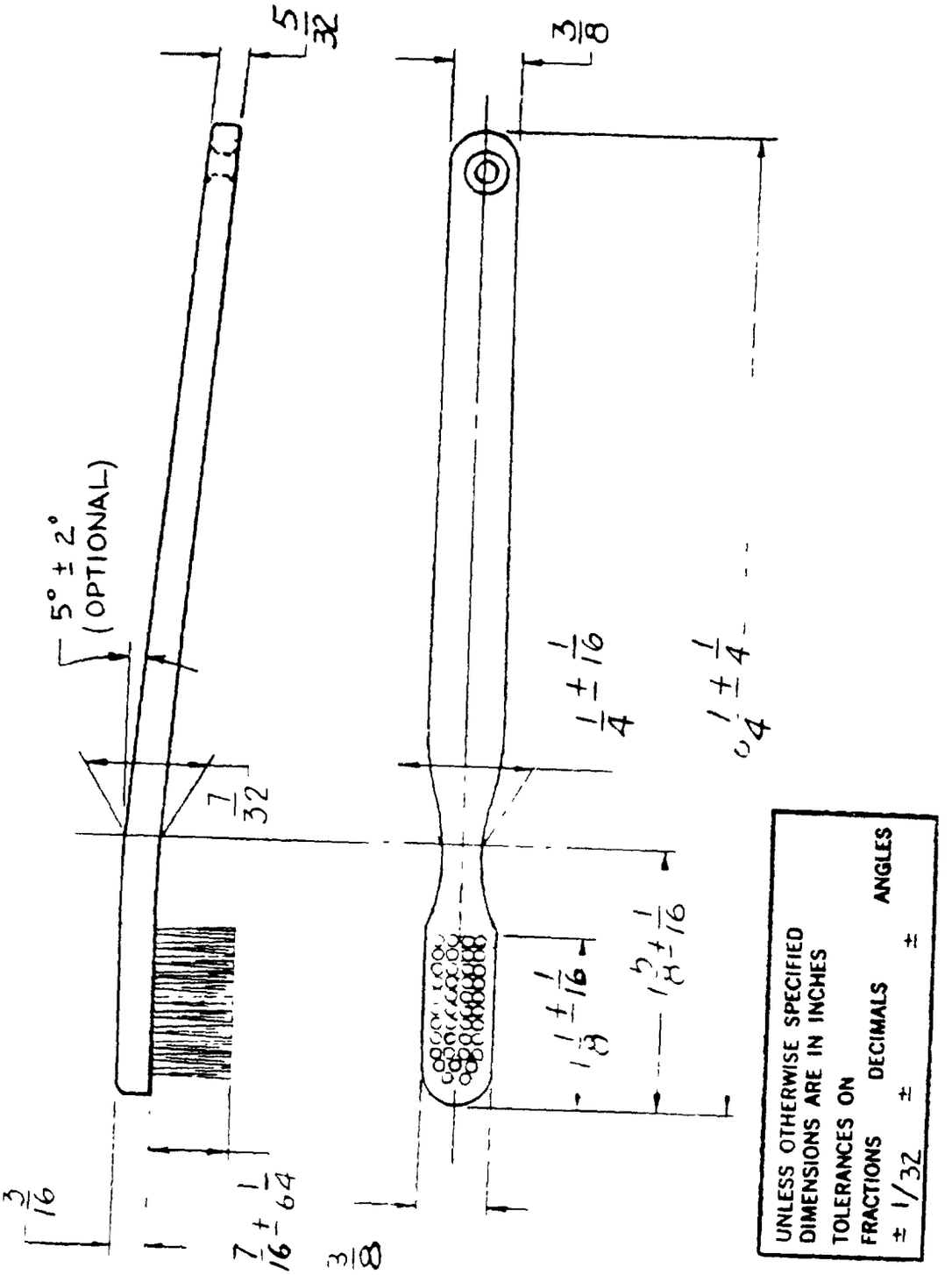
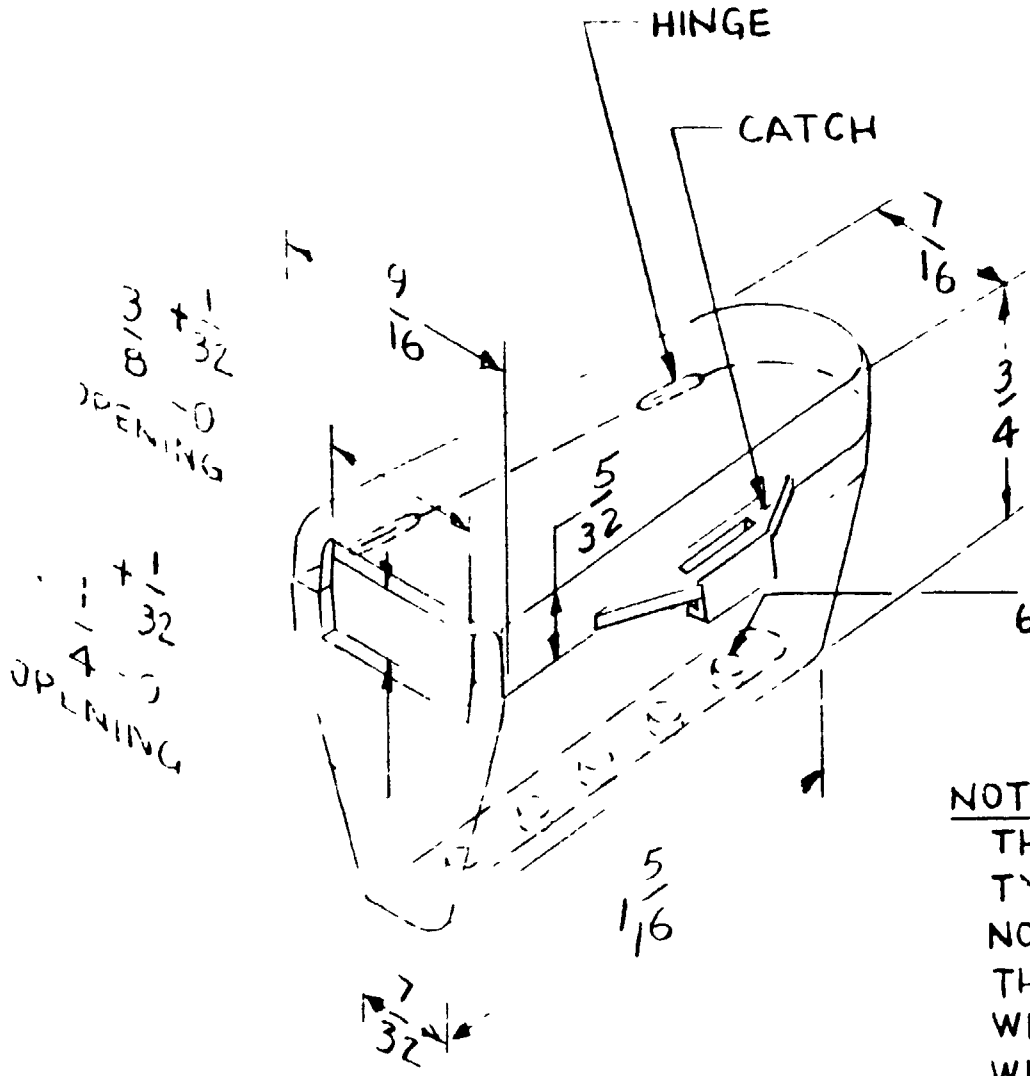


FIGURE 1 POST-SURGICAL TOOTHBRUSH

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NOTE:
THE MAINTAINER COVER SHOWN IS TYPICAL IN STYLE AND DESIGN AND IS NOT INTENDED TO RESTRICT OR PRECLUDE THE PURCHASE OF MAINTAINER COVERS WHICH ARE OTHERWISE IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE REQUIREMENTS OF THE SPECIFICATION.

UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED DIMENSIONS ARE IN INCHES		
TOLERANCES ON		
FRACTIONS	DECIMALS	ANGLES
± 1/32		

FIGURE 2 MAINTAINER COVER FOR TOOTHBRUSH

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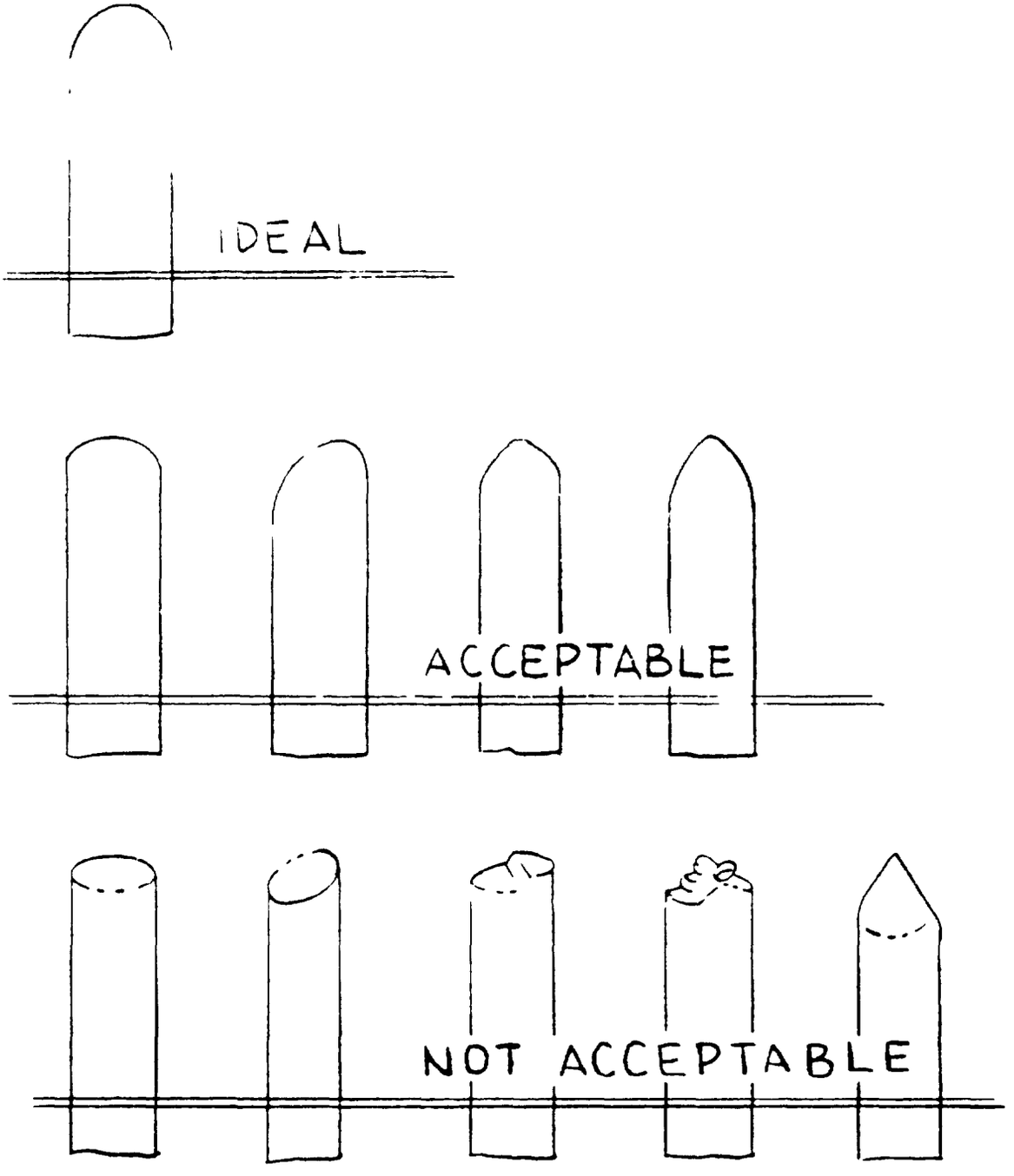


FIGURE 3 POST-SURGICAL TOOTHBRUSH BRISTLE ACCEPTABILITY

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53996	TOOTHBRUSH, POST-SURGICAL, Ultra-soft

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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